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PHOTOS BY JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF



STORM GENERATES WALLS OF WATER

New England began to feel the effects of Hurricane Erin Thursday, with the area around Point Judith Lighthouse in Narragansett, R.I., feeling the ferocity of the waves. At left, the winds whipped around Naomi Fish, 4, from Hagerstown, Md., as she walked along Rose Nulman Park. **B2.**

MGH botched gender surgeries, suits allege

Claims reveal perils of advancing field; hospital denies operation ‘experimental’

By Liz Kowalczyk
GLOBE STAFF

Surgeon Curtis Cetrulo became a leading light of a cutting-edge program at Massachusetts General Hospital soon after it opened in 2018, crafting penises for transgen-

der men — and helping plant a flag in Boston amid intensifying national competition for such procedures.

By then, Cetrulo was already well known in plastic surgery circles. He had led a Mass. General team two years earlier that com-

pleted the country’s first successful transplant of a penis, involving a 64-year-old man who had lost his penis to cancer.

For transgender patients, the surgeries he offered included a procedure called abdominal phalloplasty — using skin grafts from the abdomen to form a penis.

But now, two of his former patients are suing Cetrulo and Mass.

General for medical malpractice, alleging the gender-reassignment operations he performed were experimental and unsupported by medical research. The lawsuits said he used an untested approach to abdominal phalloplasty that caused them severe pain, disfigurement, infections, and other complications — and led to even more sur-

SURGEON, Page A7

Russia struck western Ukraine with a series of missiles in a rare attack that included a US factory. **A4.**

An appeals court rejected a \$500 million judgment against President Trump while preserving the verdict of fraud against him in New York. **A2.**

The Supreme Court allowed the Trump administration to cut \$800 million in NIH grants for the study of diseases in minority, gay, and transgender communities while legal battles over the funding continue. **A6.**

The Red Sox took the first game, 6-3, of a key series against the Yankees. **C1.**

Giving it the ol’ college try — but strictly Belichick-style

Coach talks of challenges, preparation, and UNC gridiron goals

BEN VOLIN
COMMENTARY

CHAPEL HILL, N.C. — Standing in a quiet hallway Wednesday inside the Kenan Football Center, University of North Carolina football coach Bill Belichick is asked how he would define success with his new program. *A winning record? A spot in the College Football Playoff? Beating Duke and N.C. State?*



Coach Bill Belichick: Less interference, more unity.

“I don’t know,” Belichick grumbles. “Just stringing the days together.”

Belichick’s surroundings have changed. The remote fortress in Foxborough, Mass., has been replaced by a bucolic college town. Flying Elvis has been replaced by Air Jordan and Carolina Blue. He’s coaching 19-year-old students, not professional adults. And instead of competing for a Super Bowl, he’s coaching a team that is looking to

BELICHICK, Page A10

Federal checkpoints appear to target immigrants in D.C.

Delivery drivers also detained, generating fear, anger in capital

By Chris Megerian
and Jacquelyn Martin
ASSOCIATED PRESS

WASHINGTON — Federal authorities have set up checkpoints around the nation’s capital, sometimes asking people for their immigration status and detaining them, as President Trump’s crack-down ensnared more residents each day.

Trump asserted that a crime crisis required his Republican administration’s intervention in the Democratic-led city this month, brushing aside statistics that

showed the problem was already waning. However, immigration enforcement appears to be a priority, as more than a third of people arrested in the last two weeks were in the country illegally, according to the White House.

Hundreds of federal agents and National Guard soldiers have surged into Washington, leaving some residents on edge and creating tense confrontations in the streets.

A day care was partially closed on Thursday when staff became afraid to go to work because they heard about federal agents nearby. An administrator asked parents to keep their children at home if possible.

Other day cares have stopped taking kids on daily walks because of fears about

TRUMP, Page A6

Abuse case leads state to halt use of shelter

Migrant alleges sex assault in Amherst; workers fired

By Deirdre Fernandes
GLOBE STAFF

The Healey administration has temporarily stopped housing additional families with a homeless shelter operator in Western Massachusetts while it investigates allegations that an employee forced a woman at an Amherst facility into a sexual relationship and threatened her with deportation if she crossed him.

A second worker for the Center for Human Development, one of the state’s larger operators of homeless shelters, is also accused of sexually harassing the same woman, a mother of an infant. Both workers were fired in July.

The drastic action follows Governor Maura Healey’s decision to end the use of hotels that had hosted a surge of homeless and migrant families but had cost about \$1 billion a year and was riddled with problems.

Overseeing the smaller, free-standing shelters where the state has moved some of the hotel population and ensuring they are safe are proving to be

SHELTER, Page A7

SE Mass. may be bellwether on job market

Applicants find terrain rocky, opportunities few

By Omar Mohammed
GLOBE STAFF

REHOBOTH — Kim Chrystie has been looking for a job for more than a year.

Last summer, the 54-year-old marketing executive was laid off from her remote role following a merger at her firm. She has been looking for a new role ever since, waking up early in her Rehoboth home, grabbing her coffee, and spending four to six hours a day job searching, focusing on roles close to her aging parents, who live just over the Rhode Island line.

Her days are spent scouring LinkedIn and shooting off applications. Her search has become like a full-time job.

“It’s brutal,” she said. More people in the Commonwealth are looking for work than there are jobs available, analysts say. It’s now taking job-seekers longer to get hired. Employers are skittish about recruiting workers as increased tariffs, cuts in research investment from the federal government, reduced

JOBS, Page A10

Jobless rates

FALL RIVER

6.2%
in July

5.9%
July 2024

NEW BEDFORD

6.6%
July

6.2%
July 2024

STATEWIDE

4.8%
July

NATIONAL

4.2%
July

SHERIFF ARRAIGNED



PAT GREENHOUSE/GLOBE STAFF

Suffolk Sheriff Steven W. Tompkins (left) and his attorney, Martin G. Weinberg, emerged from Joseph Moakley US Courthouse in South Boston on Thursday after pleading not guilty to extortion charges at his arraignment. **B1.**



A wave review

Friday: Windy, warmer. High 75-80, low 60-65.
Saturday: Breezy, hot. High 82-87, low 62-67.
High tide: 11:22, 11:33.
Sunrise: 5:59. Sunset: 7:34.
Weather and comics, **G6-7.**
Obituaries, **C9.**

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